

## KARNAIL SINGH (1904–76)

A graduate of Thomson Engineering College in Roorkee, Uttarakhand, Karnail Singh was no stranger to challenges. He started his career with the North Western Railway (now in Pakistan) in 1928, focusing mostly on special projects, such as the reconstruction of the Quetta line after the 1935 earthquake and building the lines to Hindubagh–Fort Sandeman and Fort Abbas–Hotwala in Bahawalpur. However, it was the Assam Rail Link Project, completed in a record time of two years, which proved to be his greatest achievement. He was involved in the construction of the Saraighat rail-and-road bridge over the Brahmaputra as well. He was appointed as chairman of the Railway Board in April 1960.

**“Turbulent rivers were bridged, jungles cleared, and the monsoon outwitted.”**

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